

has already been embraced in a big way—the Aadhaar project is a case in point. UIDAI is built on an open, scalable and secure architecture to meet the needs of the Aadhaar project. Similarly, by using Red Hat technology, the NSE has been able to reduce its costs by close to 80 per cent in some areas. Some other examples are the BSE, EPFO, MyGov, etc, where Red Hat continues to help organisations design solutions based on open source.

Q Please trace Red Hat's growth over two decades in the open source domain.

Since our earliest days, Red Hat has had a company culture rooted in open source principles, which creates part of our strategic competitive advantage. This choice to be open is not always easy.

We started 25 years ago with a subscription revenue model. At that time, people laughed at the idea and were confident that such a model would never work. This confidence was further boosted when the public realised that Red Hat was based on open source products. Open source at the time was still adopted on an experimental basis and proprietary software was considered more secure.

However, fast forward 25 years, and Red Hat has not only proved everyone wrong by becoming one of the world's largest open source companies, but it is the first USD 3 billion open source company. It is listed on the S&P 500 and has had 66 consecutive quarters of revenue growth. Today, we offer a wide product portfolio that spans across the cloud, middleware, storage, virtualisation and management. No other company comes close to our portfolio stack in the open source space. Also, industry-wise, 100 per cent of Fortune 500 companies use Red Hat products and solutions – airlines, telcos, commercial banks, the US Executive Department, etc. The company has been recognised by Forbes in its list of Top 25 'World's

Most Innovative Companies (August 2016)'. Red Hat Enterprise Linux is the global growth leader and Linux market share leader of new licence paid shipments and subscriptions for operating systems and sub-systems.

“In my view, there are many key drivers of open source adoption in India. One is the fact that ours is the fastest growing major economy; second is the impetus given to large scale infrastructure projects by government led initiatives like Digital India or Make in India and third, all this is backed by a huge pool of developers who not only use open source but also actively contribute to the community.”

We saw how open source development and licensing unlocked the potential to create better software for our customers. And since then, the same open principles have been unlocking our potential to improve anything and everything, from hardware and education to civic engagement and leadership. Further, 25 years from now, Red Hat believes it will continue to advance the power of open source to unlock the world's potential.

Q What are the challenges faced by enterprises today?

The rapidly changing digital technologies and the convergence of the physical and digital worlds is driving up IT complexities. Enterprises need IT infrastructure that delivers speed, scalability, flexibility and faster innovation to help the business

flourish. Applications and solutions built on Red Hat open source are easy to integrate with existing systems and also third-party solutions, leading to faster business processes, making the organisation more agile and efficient.

Q How is the role played by open source in AI and the cloud going to impact the ecosystem?

Open source has made way for many technological advancements, including cloud computing, AI, IoT and blockchain. The open source community is much larger and quicker to innovate than any single vendor's engineering team. A lot of companies have realised that at the infrastructural level, they can only do so much alone, but when efforts are combined, extraordinary things happen. As a result, more and more organisations across verticals ranging from automobiles and banks to consumer products are now contributing to, distributing and using open source software within their enterprises and product portfolios.

Q How do Red Hat's offerings enable enterprises to drive innovation and strategy?

We at Red Hat always strive to understand that our customers' business needs are key to their success. Thus, we are able to create a seamless customer experience for them. One uniqueness of Red Hat's business is our 'value of subscription'. The applications and infrastructure that companies need to run are changing at a rapid rate. With a Red Hat subscription, customers not only get a robust, scalable and flexible IT application platform that meets their performance, security and budgetary goals, they get access to world-class expertise and a culture of innovation and collaboration that supports them throughout their entire infrastructure life cycle. In addition, customers have an insight into our product roadmaps so they can plan